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# Technical Tip: Use the FortiGate API to recover an IPsec pre-shared key in plain text format

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|---|---|
| **Description** | This article describes how to recover an IPsec pre-shared key in plain text format using the FortiGate API. |
| **Scope** | FortiGate. |

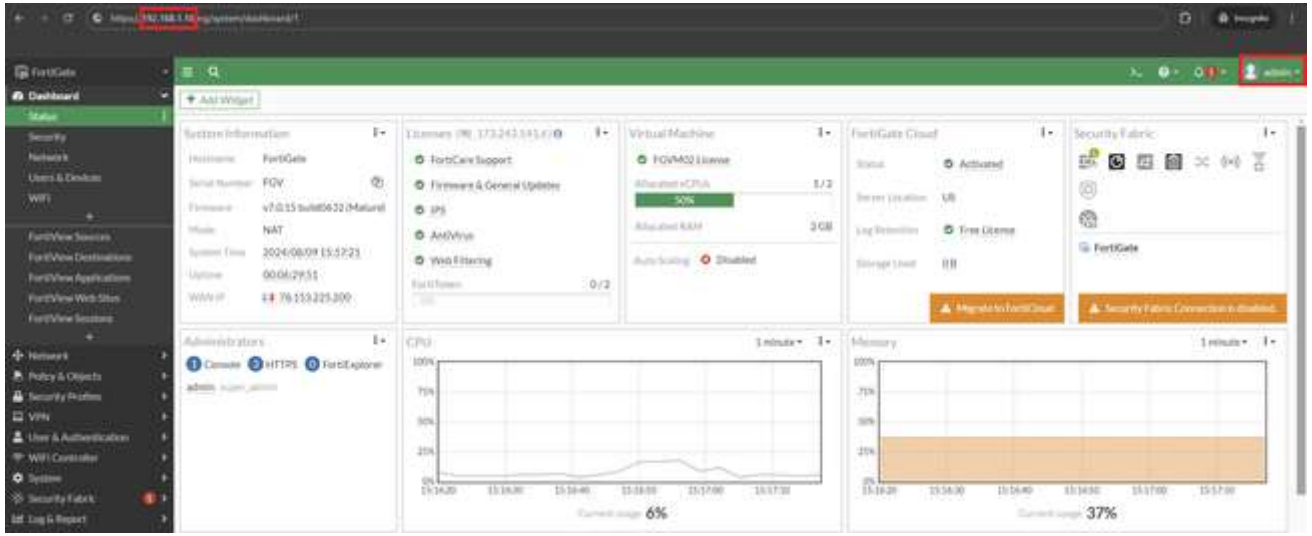
**Solution**

**Note:**

This article assumes that the admin has an IPsec tunnel set up with a pre-shared key defined, but has forgotten the actual plain text of that key. For demonstration purposes, this article will use a VPN tunnel with a pre-shared key of 'My_PSK'.

Although the pre-shared key 'My_PSK' is known for this example, the focus is to help the admin recover the pre-shared key in plain text format.

Log in into the FortiGate GUI using the **super_admin** profile:



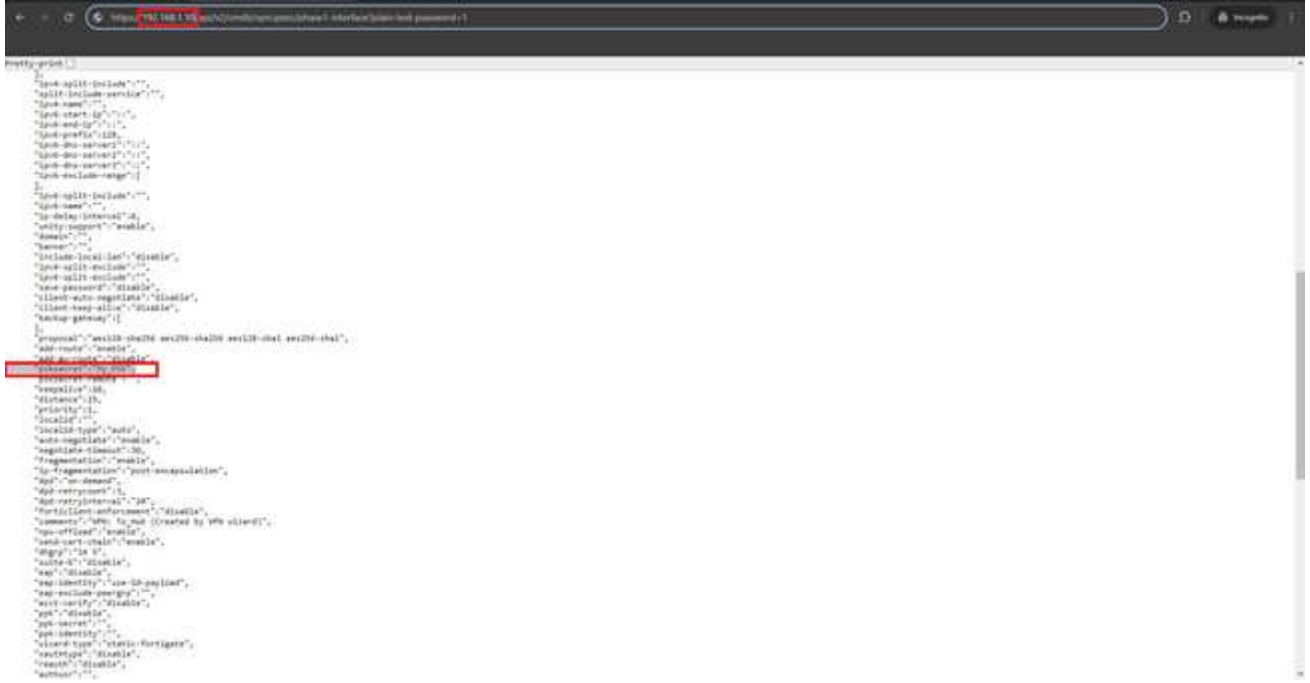
Open a new tab in the browser (such as Firefox or Google Chrome) and use the following path to obtain the PSK in plain text:

For all tunnels:

```
https://FortiGate_IP/api/v2/cmdb/vpn.ipsec/phase1-interface?plain-text-password=1
```

For a specific tunnel:

```
https://FortiGate_IP/api/v2/cmdb/vpn.ipsec/phase1-interface/TEST_S2S?plain-text-password=1
```



**Important:**

When the firewall is operating in **multi-VDOM mode**, and needs to retrieve the **preshared key** for a specific VDOM, ensure to access the firewall through an **interface associated with the same VDOM**. Accessing the firewall via an interface in a different VDOM may restrict visibility or access to the required configuration.

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